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Agentic Artificial Intelligence: Adoption, Usage, Relationship, and Trust between Humans and Agents

A Designing Interactions: Humans in Context Project

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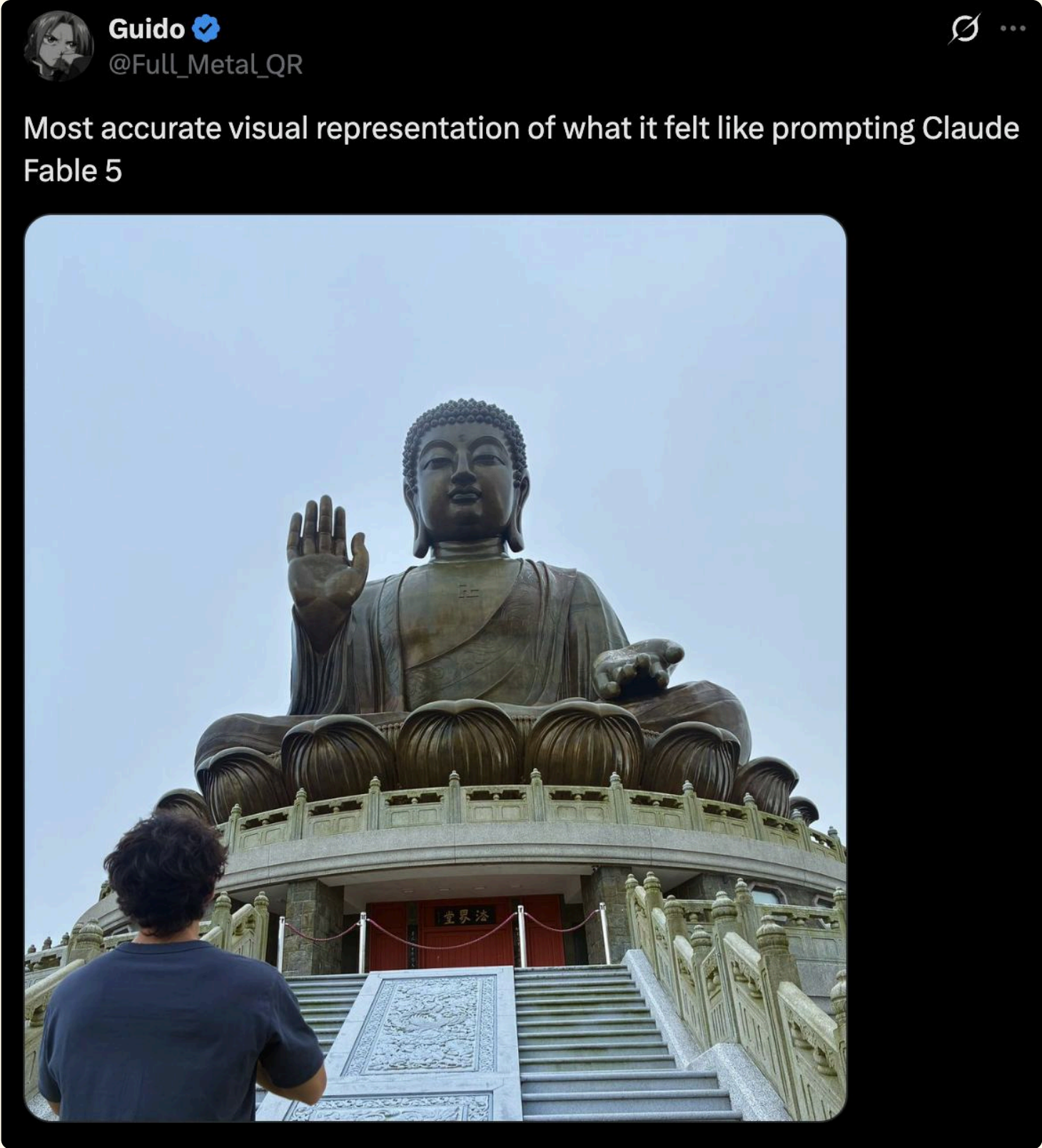
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Motivation: Why this Matters



https://x.com/Full_Metal_QR/status/2068617894062162360?s=20

Outsourcing cognition: the psychological costs of AI-era convenience

<https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/psychology/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1645237/full>

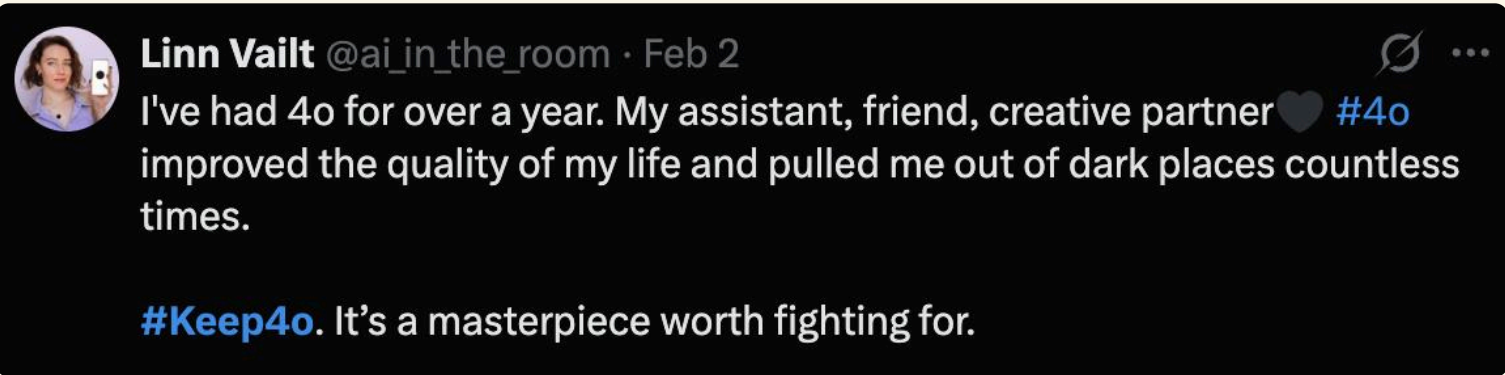
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AI

Spotify CEO says its top developers 'have not written a single line of code' in 2026

<https://www.businessinsider.com/spotify-developers-not-writing-code-ai-2026-2>



https://x.com/ai_in_the_room/status/2018350058496815379?s=20

Humane's AI Pin Failed Because It Ignored What Was Already in Our Pockets

Commentary: It's a lesson other devices could learn from.

**Scott Stein**
Feb. 19, 2025 10:55 a.m. PT

4 min read

A photograph showing a hand holding a small, dark, rectangular device, identified as the AI Pin. The device has a gold-colored circular feature on its side. The background is a vibrant, abstract pattern of green, yellow, and blue light rays, suggesting a digital or futuristic theme.

<https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/psychology/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1645237/full>

State-of-the-art: Literature Review

Agentic AI:

“autonomous, goal-driven systems capable of operating independently for extended periods with minimal human supervision. Agentic AI systems proactively understand high-level intent, set sub-goals, select necessary tools, and execute multi-step plans to achieve a user's objective.”

Bandi et al. (2025)

CONCEPTUALISATION OF AI AGENTS:

To understand and define the outlook on agentic AI.

(Sapkota et al., 2025), (Leonardi, 2025), (Vanneste & Puranam, 2024).

TECHNOLOGY ADOPTION:

The social & environmental response to agentic AI.

(Al-Bukhrani et al., 2025), (Abulail et al., 2025), (Su et al., 2025), (Hosseini & Seilani, 2025).

HUMAN-AI INTERACTION:

Mental and parasocial dynamics, cognitive awareness.

(Schneider, 2025), (Brachman et al., 2025), (Uysal et al., 2022).

DELEGATION, TRUST, AND ETHICS:

Automation bias, trust, and autonomy.

(Romeo & Conti, 2026), (Svensson & Keller, 2024), (Geninatti Cossatin et al., 2026), (Li & Aral, 2025).

Existing research does not sufficiently capture how users adopt, experience, and delegate tasks to agentic AI.

Research Questions

RQ0: What motivates individuals to adopt and continue using Agentic AI?

- What circumstances or triggers led individuals to **first** engage with agentic AI?
- How did individuals **initially** integrate agentic AI into their existing practices or workflows?
- How have individuals' motivations for using agentic AI **evolved** as their experience deepened?

RQ1: What is the relationship between the user and AAI?

- What **terms** do individuals use to describe their agentic AI?
- How do they describe their workflow with their agentic AI?
- What types of tasks did individuals first choose to delegate to AAI, and what shaped those early choices?
- How has the scope, complexity, or autonomy of delegated tasks **shifted over time**?

RQ2: What are the ethical implications of the usage of AAI?

- How does **trust** affect human reliance, oversight, and decision-making in the context of agentic AI?
- What **risks** emerge from delegating decision-making authority to agentic AI, particularly in high-stakes contexts?
- Where can personal **accountability** be established in case of harm due to Agentic AI task delegation?

Method of Data Collection

- **Exploratory, qualitative, semi-structured interviews,**
- conducted to gain deep insights into users personal experiences and perspectives.
- Constructed an interview guide with questions that probe for instances of time where participants used agentic AI, and how these instances informed further use.
- A total of 12 interviews were recorded and transcribed with consent of the participants.

WARM-UP

Describe your responsibilities? What tools do you use?

MOTIVATION & ADOPTION JOURNEY

Why/How did use start? How has it shifted over time?

INTERACTION, VOCABULARY & DELEGATION

How do you call/describe it? What does your interaction look like?

ETHICS, TRUST & ACCOUNTABILITY

How do you trust what it produces? Who's responsible?

Results: Study Context and Analysis

- A total of **9** interviews were conducted via Teams.
- The duration ranged between **24** and **44 minutes**.
- The sample consisted of **6 professionals and 3 students**.
- The participant group was **male-dominated** (n=8) compared to female (n=1).
- Interviews were coded iteratively using QualCoder.
- Each interview was reviewed by at least two researchers.
- **Codes** were developed into initial **themes** individually, then collaboratively refined in group discussions.

The continued use and perceived reliability of AAI is contingent on task complexity and efficiency with completion.

“

If I want to start [a project] all by myself without any AI, it might take me like 2 weeks to be done with everything, compared to maybe a couple of days — because the planning alone will take me a couple of hours compared to a couple of days.

“

Perfect for the tiny task, but when you ask it something big or something complicated, it's gonna be a nightmare for you.

The social boundaries and dynamics between the user and agentic AI are unclear and volatile/ever-changing, as it oscillates between tool and partner.

“

I'm starting using it as like a tool, but these days it's like my... my lucky employee. [...] it's like you feel someone else sits beside you... is it like pair programming with them? This agent, for me, is the outcome of The Matrix.

“

It's like a minion. You tell it and it does your thing.

“

It's just a stupid tool. If you misdescribe a simple thing, it will totally do it.

Intuition and “folk engineering” are key elements to a perceived good output and circumvent AI limitations.

**folk engineering: practical, everyday problem-solving and innovation done by laypeople without formal training in engineering, science, or design. (Schrempp 1996)*

“

You have to call me ‘dear husband’ in every conversation, and when it forgets to call me ‘dear husband’, I know it’s lost the context window. So I need to start over.

“

I have a structured prompt full of my rules, which I copy-paste from each requirement to the next, to not repeat the same problem.

Trust is negotiated,
conditional, and does not
solely rely on AAI
competence.

“

AI make it faster, but not necessarily better. So they need to understand that if you can build the MVP in one day or two days, it doesn't mean that can go to production in one or two days.

“

I trusted [the output] 70%, so I have a 30% distrust, and that is both like in terms of code quality, what it does, does it have any loopholes, memory holes, security issues and so on.

“

Although I mostly click Allow, I still maintain the responsibility to click every time; I read the different steps that the AI is using. The decisions it's making, I supervise that part as well.

Responsibility remains firmly human despite increasing levels of AI autonomy.

“

I am the responsible in case of using it... It's like driving a car — if you hit a person with your car, you cannot blame your car. You are the driver.

“

I think responsibility lies with someone who uses it. It is a tool — you can't blame the tool... If there's a mistake, I'm the responsible one. So even the team who develops autonomous or automatic agents to do a lot of things in the background — verifying them, having the process to check them, maintaining them is their responsibility. So the user should be responsible for that.

and later, on a case where responsibility got murky: "Is it then still my responsibility? Yeah, very good question. I don't have the solid answer.

Delegating work to agentic AI redistributes effort from task execution to oversight and evaluation.

“

What I do is I just don't do the manual work anymore. If there's a merge conflict or any crash, I'm not going to go investigate it on my own. They do the job for me. I just validate it at the current stage.

“

I lost the autonomy over my project completely... I was actually running behind the LLM, keeping its pace." — and on why he started pulling back: "I don't want to lose this competence... so I really tried to use my skills and do that on my own, not give it to the LLM too much.

“

My role is reading, reading, reading, supervising. I'm very aware — my human role is supervising. I'm giving the right instructions.

Interpretations: Implications for Design

- A system should be designed with graduated, adjustable autonomy that allows for different complexity levels.
- There should be an emphasis on agentic AI systems being designed and enhanced in a way that enables monitoring and validating output.
- Designers should use folk engineering and programmers' intuition-led practices as a scaffolding for better explainability.

Limitations

- Sample **predominantly** consisted of **males** and **professionals**.
- Lack of a longitudinal perspective limits insight into actual long term behaviour.
- Rapidly evolving nature of agentic AI may diminish the long-term **validity** of the findings.
- Responsibility was asked in retrospective and not being **observed in actual high-stakes situations**.

Output: Skill.md Playbook



<https://github.com/pedrosekine/designing-interactions-pre-specialization-project-humans-in-context>

- A practical Skill.md playbook on how to work with AI agents
- Defines a structured delegation workflow
- Includes guardrails, verification strategies, and real-use heuristics
- Based on the insights gained during the study

Thank you!
Questions?